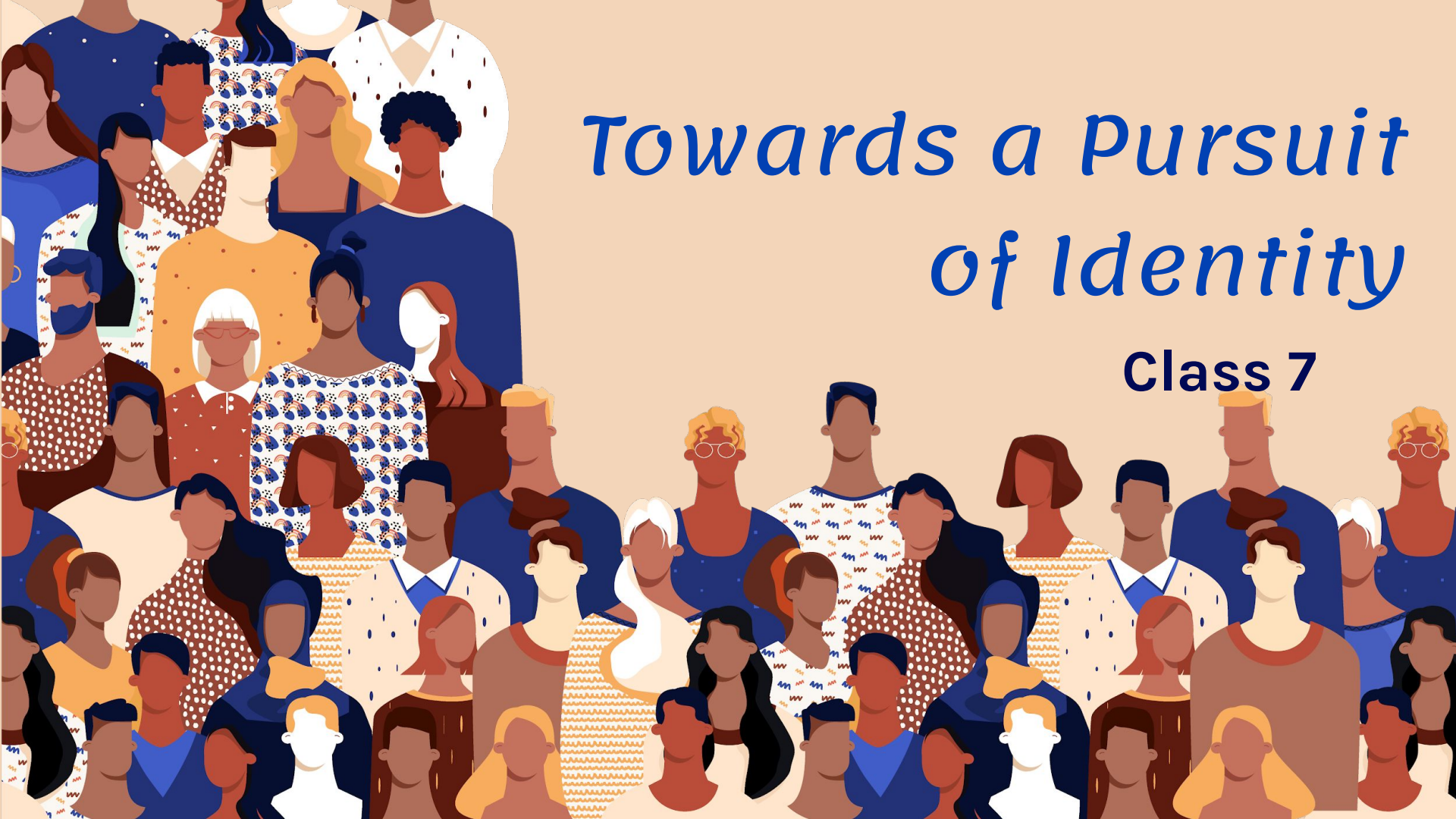




Towards a Pursuit of Identity

Class 7



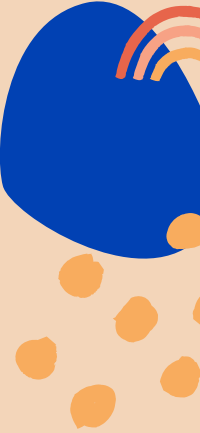
“Identity work is not an add-on to teaching; it is the work. When we allow students to bring their identities into the classroom, we create space for authentic learning.”

However ...

“Before educators begin to teach students to know themselves, teachers must do their own self-work. This work involves unpacking their own histories and identities” (Muhammad, 2020, p. 78).



Layers of Me: Unearthing Identity





Intersectionality Theory:

Explains how people face discrimination in unique ways based on the mix of their social identities, such as race, gender, and class. This theory highlights that these identities don't exist separately but overlap, leading to complex experiences with discrimination. By recognizing these intersections, intersectionality broadens social justice to include a more diverse range of experiences that traditional, separate identity approaches might miss.



I am a woman's rights. I have as much muscle as any man, and can do as much work as any man. I have plowed and reaped and husked and chopped and mowed, and can any man do more than that? I have heard much about the sexes being equal; I can carry as much as any man, and can eat as much too, if I can get it. I am as strong as any man that is now. As for intellect, all I can say is, if women have a pint and man a quart - why can't she have her little pint full? You need not be afraid to give us our rights for fear we will take too much, for we can't take more than our pint'll hold. The poor men seem to be all in confusion, and don't know what to do. Why children, if you have woman's rights, give it to her and you will feel better. You will have your own rights, and they won't be so much trouble.

I can't read, but I can hear. I have heard the Bible and have learned that Eve caused man to sin. Well if woman upset the world, do give her a chance to set it right side up again.

-Sojourner Truth, Woman's Rights Convention in Akron, Ohio on May 29, 1851



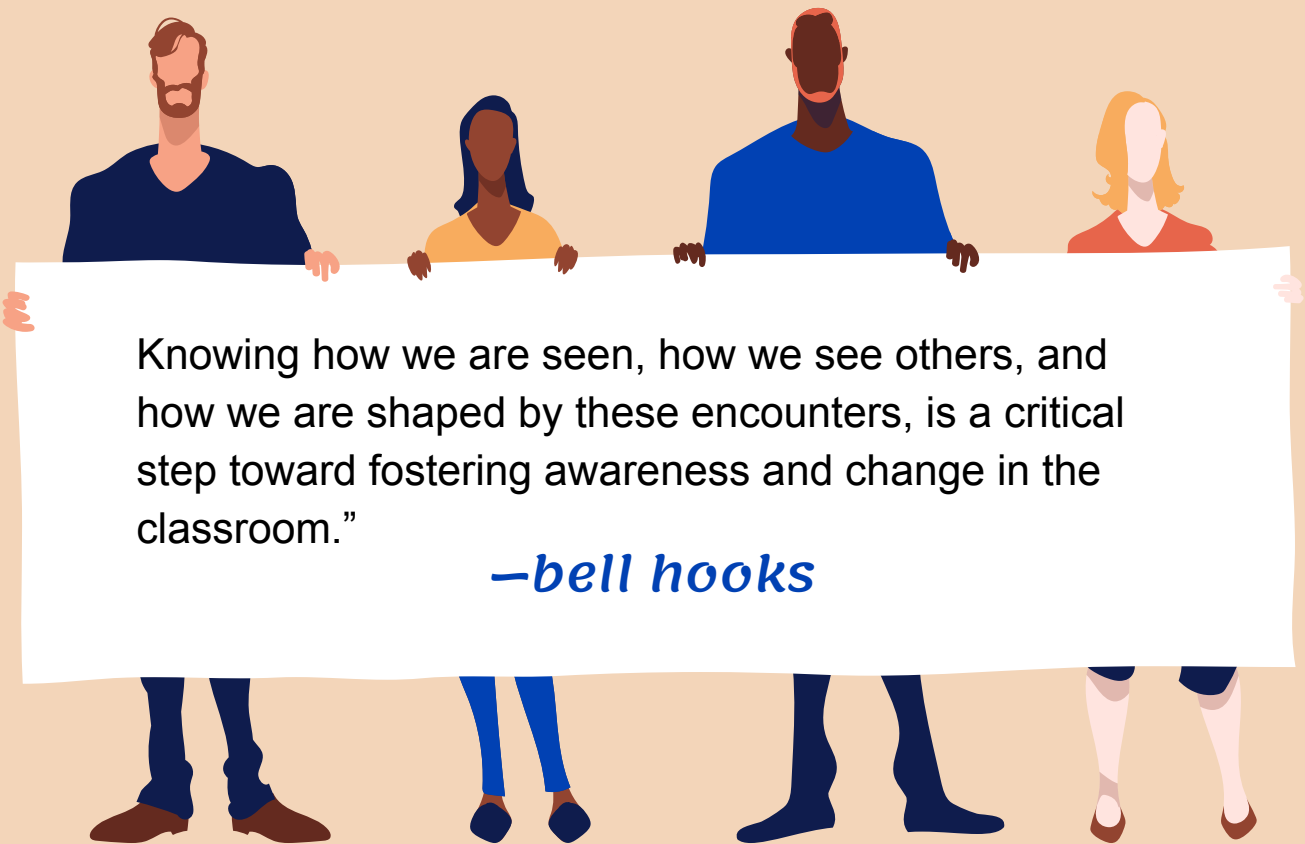
Mother of Intersectionality

“Identity isn’t simply a self-contained unit. It is a relationship between people and history, people in communities, people in institutions. So, schools do a good job when they understand that and when they commit themselves to curricular development ...for all students to understand the histories that have brought us to this particular moment...to be responsive to their student populations and to the communities out of which the students come from.” ~Kimberle Crenshaw







An illustration of four stylized human figures of different ethnicities and genders standing behind a large white rectangular sign. From left to right: a man with a beard in a dark blue shirt, a woman in a yellow shirt, a man in a blue shirt, and a woman in a red shirt. The background is a solid light orange color. In the top left corner, there is a blue circular shape with orange and brown wavy lines extending from it. In the top right corner, there is a rainbow with orange and yellow bands. In the bottom left corner, there is a white circle with blue and brown wavy lines. In the bottom right corner, there are several brown, irregular shapes resembling rocks or pebbles.

Knowing how we are seen, how we see others, and how we are shaped by these encounters, is a critical step toward fostering awareness and change in the classroom.”

—bell hooks

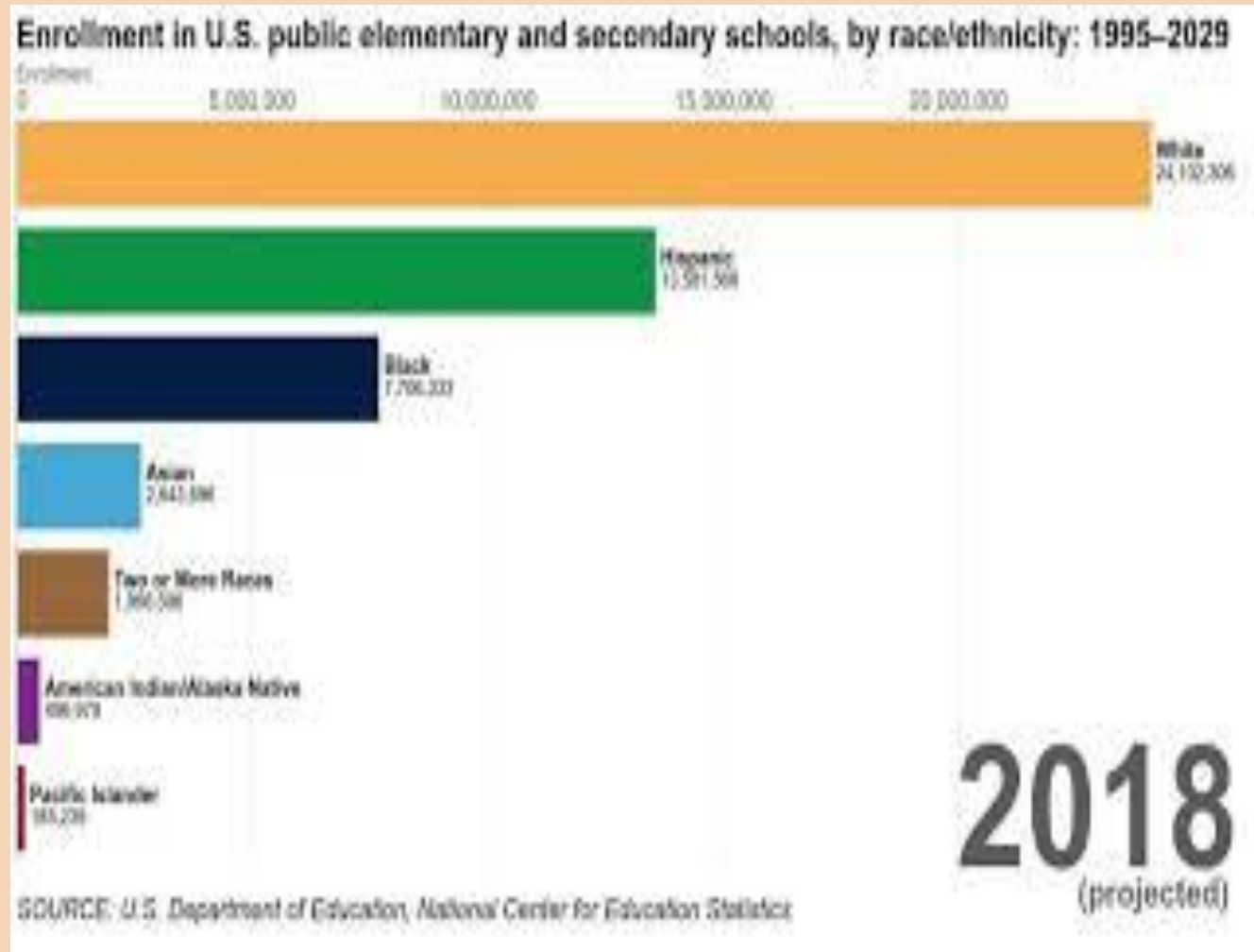
An illustration featuring four stylized human figures of diverse backgrounds (two men and two women) holding a large white banner. The background is a solid light orange color, decorated with abstract shapes: a blue circle with red wavy lines in the top left, a rainbow and an orange circle in the top right, and a white circle with blue and red wavy lines in the bottom left. There are also some brown circular shapes in the bottom right. The banner contains a quote in black text and the name 'Maya Angelou' in blue italicized text.

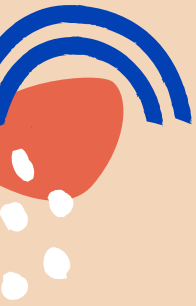
“We all should know that diversity makes for a rich
tapestry, and we must understand that all the threads
of the tapestry are equal in value no matter their
color.”

—Maya Angelou

U.S.A Changing Demographics, Belonging & Impact

*Note: Changing Demographic in USA
k-12 1995-2029 (NCES, 2020)*





Why Intersectionality Theory Matters:

1. Intersectionality Reveals Systemic Barriers
2. It Ensures Inclusive and Equitable Teaching
3. It Expands Literacy Beyond Skills
4. It Prepares Students for a Complex World

"How does an intersectional approach change the way we think about teaching, learning, and literacy?"



Activity 2: Weaving Perspectives: A Layered Strand Discussion



Personal Reflection



Theoretical Application



**Societal/Cultural
Implications**



Synthesizing

